PAULA A. LOPEZ VILLALBA

LSA Department of Economics
University of Michigan
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Education

University of Michigan

Ph.D. in Economics - expected April 2027
M.A. in Economics, 2022

Universidad de San Andrés, Argentina

M.A. in Economics, 2016
B.A. in Economics, 2015 *(Cum Laude)*

Research Interests

Labor Economics, Development Economics, Family Economics

Working Papers

"Child Support and Labor Supply in a High-Informality Setting" *(Job Market Paper)* - with Rosario Didier

"The Effects of Coca Cultivation on Peruvian Local Economic Development" with Joaquin Endara Cevallos

"Ideology and corruption: Policies and People" with Christian Ruzzier *(Submitted, under review)*

Publications

"The Long-Term Effect of Military Conscription on Personality and Beliefs" with Gabriela Ertola Navajas, Martín A. Rossi and Antonia Vazquez. ***The Review of Economics and Statistics***, 104(1), 2022

"Firm-level Productivity in Latin America and The Caribbean" with Lucas Figal Garone, Alessandro Maffioli and Christian Ruzzier. ***Research in Economics***, 74(2), 2020

Fellowships and Awards

Fall 2026 Diane Swonk Research Fellowship. University of Michigan

Fall 2025 Rackham One-Term Fellowship. University of Michigan

2016 Merit-based scholarship - M.A. in Economics. Universidad de San Andrés

2012 Merit-based scholarship - B.A. in Economics. Universidad de San Andrés

Conferences and Presentations

2026: NICEP 2026 Conference (Nottingham, UK), MDev 2026 Conference, Michigan Labor Lunch, Michigan DevWorkshop

2025: Workshop on Gender and Household Inequality CAF-WELAC (Buenos Aires, Argentina), 118th NTA Annual Conference on Taxation (Boston, USA), Michigan Labor Lunch, Michigan DevWorkshop

$\leq$ 2020: 2019 LACEA Annual Meeting (Puebla, Mexico)

Research Grants

"Child Support and Labor Supply in a High-Informality Setting"
Rackham International Research Award 2025 ($10,000)
Graduate Research Funding Fall 2024 ($3,000)
Graduate Research Funding Spring/Summer 2024 ($5,000)
Graduate Research Funding Fall 2023 ($5,000)

Academic Service

2024–2025 DevWorkshop Social Committee – University of Michigan

2023–2024 Graduate Program Committee – University of Michigan

2023 Ph.D. in Economics Admissions Committee - University of Michigan

2022 Women in Economics Coordinator – University of Michigan

2021–2026 External M.A. Thesis Examiner - Universidad de San Andrés

Teaching experience

University of Michigan, LSA Department of Economics
Graduate Student Instructor *(undergraduate)*

Head GSI - Intermed Micro Theory (ECON 401): Spring 2026

Head GSI - Intermed Macro Theory (ECON 402): Winter 2026

Head GSI - Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 101): Winter 2025

ECON 101: Fall 2021, Winter 2022, Fall 2022, Winter 2023

Universidad de San Andrés, Argentina
Teaching Assistant *(undergraduate)*

ECON 101: Fall 2016, Spring 2016, Fall 2018, Spring 2018, Fall 2019, Spring 2019

Labor Economics: Spring 2018

Economic Growth: Fall 2016, Fall 2018

Monetary Economics: Fall 2017, Fall 2018

History of the Economic Thought: Spring 2017, Spring 2018

International Monetary Economics: Spring 2017

Graduation Paper Workshop: Spring 2017

Research Experience

University of Michigan, Criminal Justice Administrative Records System
Research Assistant for Professor Mike Mueller Smith, Aug 2023 - April 2024

University of Michigan, LSA Department of Economics
Research Assistant for Professor Ana Reynoso, Summer 2022
Research Assistant for Professor Sara Heller, Summer 2021

Universidad de San Andrés, Department of Economics, Argentina
Research Assistant for Professor Christian Ruzzier, Mar 2017 - July 2020
Research Assistant for Professor Tommy Murphy, April - August 2018

WORK EXPERIENCE

Development Bank of Latin America (CAF), Socio-Economic Research Division

Research Assistant, Aug 2019 - July 2020

Inter-American Development Bank Group (IDBG), InterAmerican Investment Corporation (IIC)

Research Assistant, Apr 2017 - July 2019

LANGUAGE

Spanish (Native); English (Fluent); French (Fluent); Portuguese (Intermediate)

CITIZENSHIP

Argentina

REFERENCES

Sara Heller
Associate Professor of Economics
Department of Economics
University of Michigan
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Ana Reynoso
Associate Professor of Economics
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